LESSON 4

ADJECTIVES

Comparative and superlative adjectives

We compare two things with the **comparative** form of the adjective. e.g. *George is **younger** than Alex.*

When we compare three or more things (or somebody/something with the whole group), we use the **superlative** form. e.g. *George is **the youngest** player in our team.*

		COMPARATIVE	**SUPERLATIVE**
Short adjectives	cheap small big	cheap**er** small**er** bigg**er**	**the** cheap**est** **the** small**est** **the** bigg**est**
Adjectives that end in -y	funny early heavy	funni**er** earli**er** heavi**er**	**the** funni**est** **the** earli**est** **the** heavi**est**
Adjectives that end in 2 syllables or more	careful boring expensive interesting	**more** careful **more** boring **more** expensive **more** interesting **less** interesting (for negative comparisons)	**the most** careful **the most** boring **the most** expensive **the most** interesting **the least** interesting (for negative comparisons)
Irregular adjectives	far good bad	**further** **better** **worse**	**the furthest** **the best** **the worst**

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For short adjectives with one vowel + one consonant, double the consonant: e.g. *hot/ hotter/ the hottest; fat/ fatter/ the fattest.*

Than is often used after a comparative adjective.

France is **bigger than** Belgium.

Gina is **more intelligent than** Sally.

A Honda is **less expensive than** a Rolls Royce.

Much can come before the comparative to give emphasis.

She's **much nicer than** her sister.

History is **much more interesting** than Grammar.

The is used before superlative adjectives.

He's **the funniest** boy in the class.

She's **the most beautiful** girl in the world.

As ... as shows that something is the same or equal.

Jack is **as tall as** Jill.

I'm **as worried as** you are.

Not as/so ... as shows that something isn't the same or equal.

She **isn't as intelligent as** her brother.

My car **wasn't so expensive as** yours.

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ADVERBS

Many adverbs are formed from an adjective + **-ly**.

Adjective	Adverb
quick	quick**ly**
serious	serious**ly**
careful	careful**ly**
quiet	quiet**ly**
heavy	heavi**ly**
bad	bad**ly**

NOT all words ending in -**ly** are adverbs. Some adjectives end in -ly too.

e.g. *friendly, lively, lonely, silly, lovely*

Adjectives tell us about a *noun* (somebody or something). We use adjectives before nouns.

Sam is a **careful driver**.

We didn't go out because of the **heavy rain**.

Adverbs tell us about a *verb* (*how* somebody does something or *how* something happens).

Sam **drove carefully** along the narrow road.

We didn't go out because it was **raining heavily**.

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Compare the position of adjectives and adverbs in the sentence.

She speaks **perfect English**. (*adjective* + *noun*)

She **speaks** English **perfectly**. (*verb* + *noun* + *adverb*)

We also use some adjectives after some verbs, especially **be**, and also **look/feel/sound**.

Please **be quiet**.	Please **speak quietly**.
I **feel happy**.	The children were **playing happily**.

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